

Develop and Demonstrate Loyalty: Wrap-Up, Featuring Greg Hiebert

Coach Pat Summitt

You've got to have an unbelievable desire to compete at this point in time. An attitude. OK? I go back and say, "We're not going to lunch tomorrow night. We're going to war."

Greg Hiebert, Leadership Coach & Managing Partner

Pat Summitt is remembered by all who knew her as a great motivator. Her greatest gift was to help everyone around her instill that foundational understanding within their own spirits.

In other words, she ignited everyone she touched, and with the determination to be loyal to their deepest values. Her great power as a coach was not that she made her players fear her and answer to her.

Instead, she made them fear and answer first to themselves. She told every single Lady Vol team, "If you take a shortcut or cheat, you'll know it. And you'll keep cheating and taking shortcuts for the rest of your life."

The reason her look, also called the Pat Summitt Stare, was so powerful was because it cut through you like an X-ray to say, "You just let yourself down. I know it, but more importantly, you know it."

Loyalty, like character, starts on the inside and eventually reveals itself to the outside.

Pat said, "Value those colleagues who tell you the truth, not just what you want to hear."

When your focus is first and foremost on giving loyalty, receiving it in return is simply the natural result. You can't demand loyalty, but you can choose to be loyal and to support that decision by being 100 percent consistent in the way you speak about others.

When Mickey DeMoss and Nancy Darsh moved on from Tennessee pursuing other career opportunities after many years as assistant coaches, Pat did not waiver in the glowing, positive, deeply appreciative way she spoke about them. She stayed in constant contact when they left. She wasn't loyal when they were just there and disloyal when they weren't.

This consistency and constant loyalty spoke volumes to everyone around Pat Summitt. They knew her loyalty was not conditional. Nor was it temporary. It was unconditional and permanent.

When Pat Summitt was loyal to you, it was for life. The confidence and inspiration that result from such loyalty cannot be measured. And what a great lesson for all of us to learn and apply in our lives.

Do you value your team and treat them like family?

What areas might you need to improve so that you can develop and demonstrate loyalty every day?